

Chapter 5

THE STRUGGLE FOR INDEPENDENCE

Learning Outcomes

After studying this chapter the students will be able to:

1. Describe major historical events that led to the creation of Pakistan.
2. Recognize that events in various parts of the world affect each other.
3. Identify examples of good character from the lives of important personalities of history.
4. Identify alternative solutions to problems of the past and recognize their possible implications.
5. Recognize that particular individuals, ideas, events, and decisions have had a great impact on history.
6. Predict how events might have turned out differently if specific individuals/groups had chosen their steps differently.

British Take Control of India

In class IV we learned that the British came to India to trade. When the power of the Mughal Empire started to decrease, the British, slowly changed from being traders in India, to bringing India under control.



Through different policies, the British gained control of the most of the subcontinent by 1818. The only areas remaining independent were the areas which form Pakistan today. These areas also came under British control by 1849. The British Empire now stretched from the Khyber Pass in the North to the Indian Ocean in the south and from Balochistan in the West to Bengal in the East.

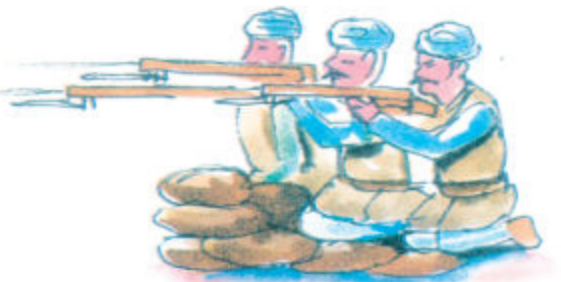


War of Independence



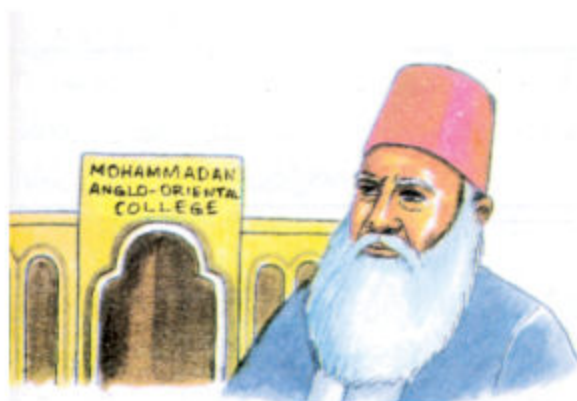
After the British conquered India, the people struggled to free India from British rule. In 1857 they fought a war for independence. There were many causes for the War.

- The British did not respect local customs and traditions.
- They introduced laws to help them expand their empire. For example, one of the laws allowed the British to take away a state if there was no heir.
- They replaced Persian with English as the official language.
- The officers in the army (all British) received a large salary but the soldiers (all Indians) were given very low salaries.
- In 1857, the soldiers heard that the cartridges given to them for their guns were greased with the fat of pigs and cows. This hurt the religious feelings of the soldiers. They refused to use them and fought the British. Many soldiers and British officers were killed.



Founding of the Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College

The British blamed the Muslims for the War of Independence and as a result they had to face many difficulties. Sir Syed Ahmed Khan, seeing the difficulties being faced by the Muslims, came forward to guide and lead them. He tried to get the British rulers to understand the reasons for the War of Independence and change their behavior towards the Muslims. At the same time, he advised the Muslims to learn English and science along with Islamic studies. For this purpose, he established the Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh, which in 1920 became the Aligarh Muslim University. His efforts resulted in the Muslims receiving a good education. It also made them aware of the need to organize themselves to struggle for their rights.



Activity

Write a note on the contributions (education, religion, political) of Sir Syed Ahmed Khan to the Muslims of the subcontinent.



The Indian National Congress

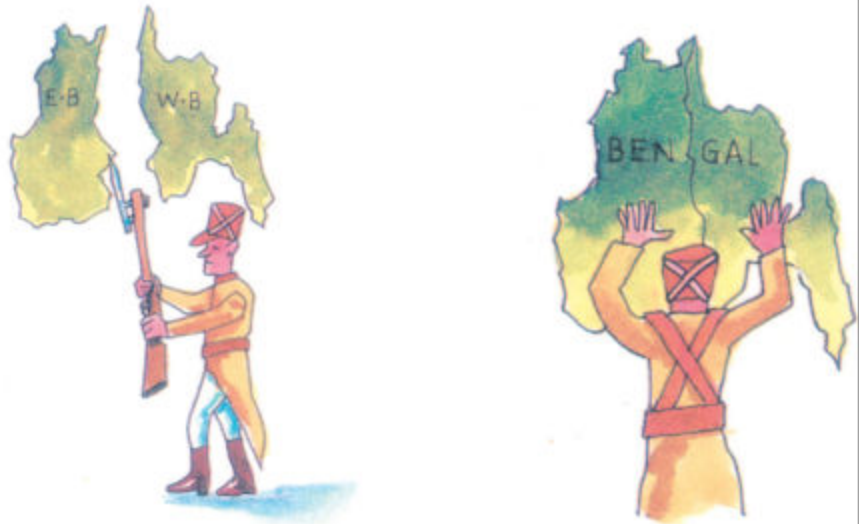
In 1885, a British, A.O Hume formed a political party by the name of Indian National Congress. This party gained in popularity with the help of the British Government. Many Prominent Hindu leaders joined this party with in a few years, this party became completely a political party of the Hindus.



The Partition of Bengal

In 1905 the British partitioned Bengal into a largely Muslim East and a mostly Hindu West. There were protests against the partition. The protests were supported by the Congress.

The British government accepted the demands of the protesters and in 1911 Bengal was reunited.



Formation of the All India Muslim League

In 1906 Nawab Salimullah and other Muslim leaders set up the All India Muslim League. They did this to protect the rights and interests of the Muslims. In 1913, they also started working for a system of self-government (Indians would rule themselves) for India. At this time Quaid-i-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah became a member of the Muslim League.



The Lucknow Pact

After joining the Muslim League, Quaid-i-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah organized a joint meeting of the Congress and Muslim League in 1916. The two parties came to an agreement known as the Lucknow Pact. A very important part of the pact was that Congress agreed to separate electorates for the Muslims (this means that Muslims would vote only for Muslims).



World War I (1914-1918)

When Britain joined World War I, hundreds of thousands of Indian soldiers fought for Britain. In 1917 when more Indian soldiers were needed, the British Prime Minister promised the Indians will be given right of self-government if more soldiers fought in the war.

Do you know?

A World War I involved many Countries. World War I was fought between the Central Powers (Germany, Austria and Turkey) and the Allies (Britain, France, Japan, Russia and USA).

Activity

On a map of the World locate the countries that fought in World War I colour the countries that were part of the Central Powers red and colour the countries that formed the Allies blue

The Khilafat Movement (1922)

When the Allies won the war, the Muslims were afraid that they would destroy the Caliphate in Turkey. The Ali Brothers, Maulana Muhammad Ali and Maulana Shaukat Ali, started the Khilafat movement to stop the Allies from destroying the Caliphate. The Khilafat Movement ended when Ataturk, a Turkish leader, overthrew the Caliph and made Turkey into a republic (people elect their own leader).

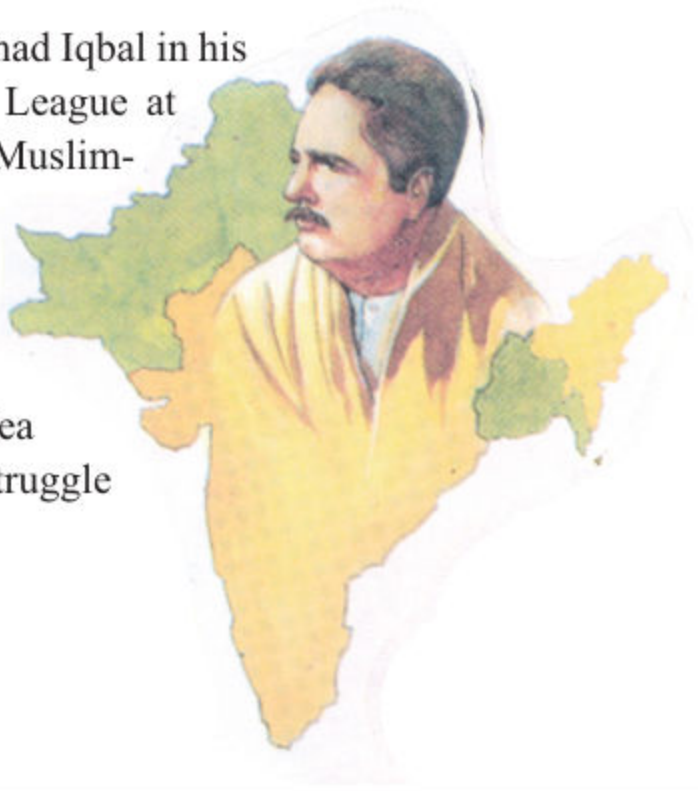


All Parties Conference

The Congress and Muslim League came together again in an All Parties Conference in 1928 to make a new constitution for India. The report of the Conference, commonly known as the Nehru Report was published in 1928. If the Nehru Report, would become the constitution it would make the Muslims a minority to be ruled by the Hindu majority. Quaid-i-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah presented a counter-proposal in 1929 consisting of "Fourteen Points". This proposal asked for equal rights for all minorities and protection of Muslim interests. The Congress rejected Jinnah's Fourteen Points.

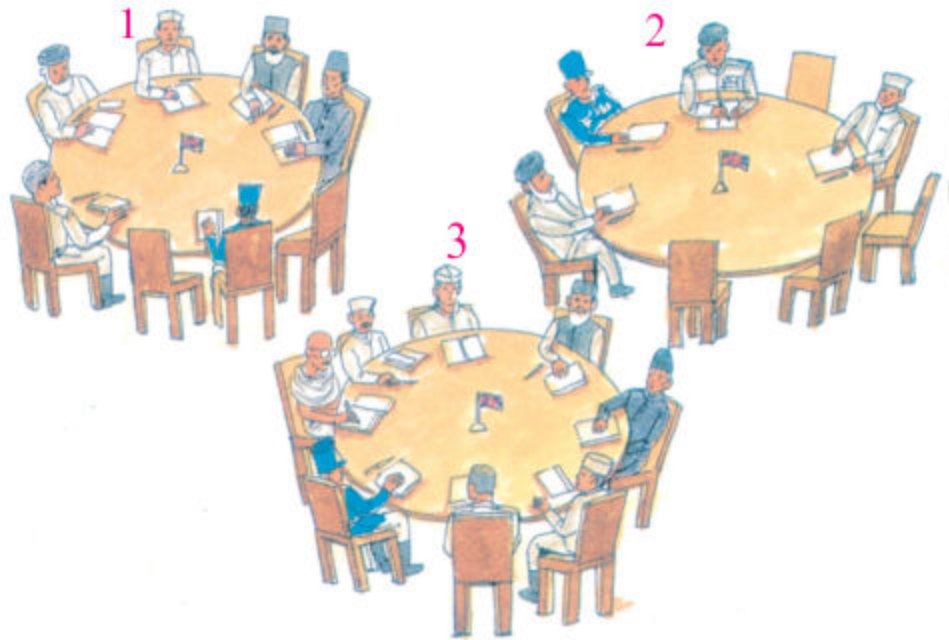
Iqbal's Call for a Separate Muslim State

In December 1930, Allama Muhammad Iqbal in his presidential address to the Muslim League at Allahabad, put forward the idea that Muslim-majority areas of the North-West of India i.e Punjab, North West Frontier, Sindh and Balochistan should form a separate Muslim state. It was the first time that such an idea was put forward. From this day the struggle for a separate country grew.



Round Table Conferences 1930-1932

Three Round Table Conferences were held in London by the British Government to work out a system of self-government for India. All three conferences failed.



Activity

List the areas proposed by Allama Muhammad Iqbal for a separate Muslim State.

The Government of India Act 1935

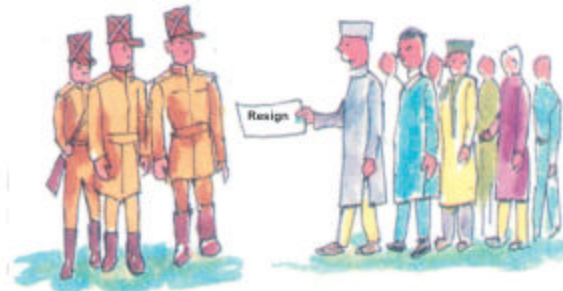
According to this act, Indians would govern themselves, but India would remain a part of the British Empire. In order for Indians to govern themselves, elections to the provincial legislatures were held in 1937. The Congress and Muslim League took part in the elections. Out of the eleven provinces, the Congress formed governments in seven and the Muslim majority parties in four.

In the provinces ruled by the Congress, a song “*Vande Mataram*” was made the national anthem which was taken from the novel, *Anand Nath* written by Bilkam Chander Chitarji. Hindi replaced Urdu and cow slaughter was banned. Because of this, the Muslims in these provinces faced many problems and difficulties. The Muslim leaders felt it would be difficult for Muslims to live their lives according to the teachings of Islam in this context and realized the need for an independent Muslim state.



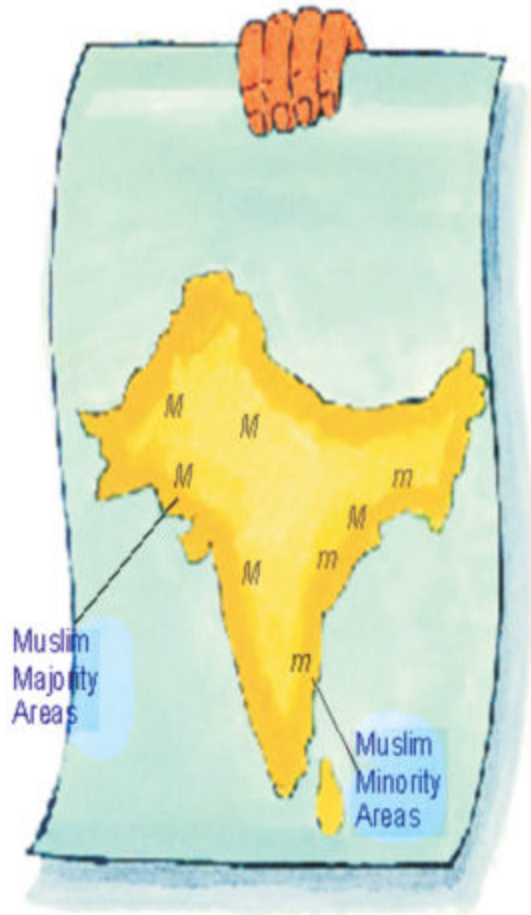
World War II

When World War II broke out in 1939, Britain wanted the Indians to help them fight the war. The Congress demanded that the British transfer power to the Indians if they wanted their cooperation in the war. The British refused. The Congress governments in the provinces resigned in protest. The Muslims observed the day—22nd December, 1939—as “the Day of Deliverance”.



Do you know?

The death of millions of people and destruction of many countries in WWII resulted in the formation of the United Nations in 1945.



The Pakistan Resolution

On 23rd March 1940, at the session of the Muslim League in Lahore, the historic resolution, now known as the “Pakistan Resolution”, was passed. The resolution stated that:

“No constitutional plan would be workable in this country or acceptable to Muslims unless it is designed on the following basic principle, namely, that geographically contiguous units are demarcated into regions which should be so constituted, with such territorial readjustments as may be necessary,

That the areas in which the Muslims are numerically in a majority, as in the north-western and eastern zones of India should be grouped to constitute independent States in which the constituent units shall be autonomous and sovereign.... Adequate, effective and mandatory safeguards should be specifically provided in the Constitution for minorities....for the protection of their religious, cultural, economic, political, administrative and other rights”.

Elections of 1945-46

When general elections were held in 1945-46, the Muslim League won all the Muslim seats in the Central Assembly. This proved that the Muslims were united under the leadership of Quaid-i-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah and his idea of a separate Muslim state.



Independence

On 14 August 1947, Lord Mountbatten transferred power from Britain to the new states of Pakistan and India through the Indian Independence Act of 1947.



Do you know?

The name Pakistan was created by Chaudhry Rehmat Ali (1895-1951), a student at Cambridge. In 1933, he made the word "Pakistan", by taking the letter 'P' from Punjab, 'A' from Afghanistan (the name he preferred to use for the North-West Frontier), 'K' from Kashmir, 'S' from Sindh and the suffix 'tan' from Balochistan.

Activity - Conflict Resolution

A conflict is a disagreement between people, groups of people or countries.

Below are some ways to resolve conflict:

Communicate- Talking about the disagreement in order to understand each other.

Negotiate- Identifying steps that can be taken to work out the conflict.

Mediate- Asking someone else, a mediator, to help the parties to work out the conflict.

Arbitrate- Asking someone else, an arbitrator, to decide for the parties.

Litigate- Going to court and letting the judge decide.

Legislate- Making a law or changing a law, so the problem will not happen again.

- a. Identify the different ways used by the people of India to resolve their conflicts.
- b. The result was the creation of two independent states India and Pakistan.
What other possible solutions could there have been?

SUMMARY

In this chapter we have learnt about the major historical events that led to the creation of Pakistan and how events in other parts of the world affected what happened in the Indian sub-continent. We have also learnt that particular individuals, ideas, events and decisions have a great impact on history and realize how events might have turned out differently if these individuals had chosen to do things differently.

EXERCISE

A. Multiple choice questions

1. For each question, three answers are given; tick the correct one.

- i. When was the war of independence fought?
a) 1757 b) 1857 c) 1957
- ii. When was the Indian National Congress founded ?
a) 1880 b) 1885 c) 1985
- iii. When was the All India Muslim League founded?
a) 1806 b) 1906 c) 2006
- iv. When was the Pakistan Resolution passed?
a) 1920 b) 1930 c) 1940
- v. Who announced the transfer of power from the British to Pakistan and India?
a) Lord Curzon b) Lord Dalhousie c) Lord Mountbatten

B. Answer the following questions

1. List three problems the Muslims faced after the failure of the War of Independence.
2. Why was the All India Muslim League formed?
3. Why did the Muslims of the Indian subcontinent demand a separate homeland?
4. Why is freedom important?
5. Make a time line to show the important events that occurred in each decade from 1857 to the independence of Pakistan in 1947.
6. Describe two important events in the 1930s and two important events in the 1940s that led to the creation of Pakistan.
7. State what effect each of the following world events had on the struggle for independence in the subcontinent: a) World War I. b) World War II.
8. State what you think might have happened: a) If the British did not come to India; b) If the Muslims did not form the All India Muslim League; c) If the British did not fight in World War II; d) If the Muslim League did not pass the Pakistan Resolution in 1940.

C. Make a table

Make a table like the one below show the individuals, ideas, events and decisions that had a great impact on the struggle for Independence.

Name of people who had an impact on the struggle for independence	List the ideas that had an impact on the struggle for independence	Name the events that had an impact on the struggle for independence	List the decision that had an impact on the struggle for independence

D. Practical work

1. Find out more about: Sir Syed Ahmed Khan, Allama Iqbal and Quaid-i-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah. Identify three good qualities in each of them.
2. Collect articles and photographs from newspapers and magazines about the struggle for independence. Make a display for your classroom.

E. Extension activity

View the film “Jinnah” and discuss it with the class. What do we learn about the personality of Quaid-i-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah from the film?